

THE BOTTLENECK · A 30-DAY PLAN

The Founder's Not-To-Do List

50 tasks to hand off in 30 days and get your week back.

A four-week plan for founders who have become the bottleneck in their own business. Tick what you still do, hand it off one week at a time, and finish with someone who owns outcomes, not tasks.



4

weeks

50

tasks

1

test on day 30

You don't have a people problem. You have a delegation problem.

You built the business. Now too much of it runs through you: the inbox, the follow-ups, the "quick" tasks only you know how to do. This list is the work founders keep doing that someone else should own. Use it with an assistant, a VA, or anyone on your team.

How to use this list

- 01** Tick every task you still do yourself. Be honest. "Sometimes" counts.
- 02** Hand off one week at a time. Start with the repetitive work and finish with someone who owns outcomes.
- 03** Hand it off messy. Don't clean up a process first. Perfection delays delegation.
- 04** Max out, but don't overwhelm. Give a little more than feels comfortable, never so much that quality slips.
- 05** By day 30, hand over outcomes, not steps. Define what goes in and what should come out, and trust the middle.

Your 30 days at a glance

	DAYS	FOCUS	TASKS
Week 1	Days 1–7	Repetitive work	13
Week 2	Days 8–14	Follow-ups	12
Week 3	Days 15–21	Systems	12
Week 4	Days 22–30	Outcomes	13

How to fill it in

☐ **Still mine**
You still do this yourself.

Sam **Hand to**
Who will own it.

☒ **Handed off**
It's theirs now. You're out.

On screen? The boxes and lines in this PDF are fillable.

Before you start

WHO YOU'RE HANDING OFF TO

DAY 1

DAY 30

No one to hand off to yet? Work through the list anyway. The tasks you tick are the job description.

The repetitive work

Low-stakes, easy to check, and safe to hand off messy. Quick wins build trust on both sides.

STILL MINE	TASK	HAND TO	HANDED OFF
☐	01 Triaging your inbox every morning	_____	☐
☐	02 Answering routine emails at 11pm	_____	☐
☐	03 Managing your own calendar	_____	☐
☐	04 Spotting and fixing calendar conflicts	_____	☐
☐	05 Taking, filing and finding meeting notes	_____	☐
☐	06 Collecting meeting recordings and transcripts in one place	_____	☐
☐	07 Cleaning up transcripts and captions	_____	☐
☐	08 Updating the tracker after a task is done	_____	☐
☐	09 Updating your CRM	_____	☐
☐	10 Designing simple graphics (e.g. in Canva)	_____	☐
☐	11 Editing short videos (e.g. in CapCut)	_____	☐
☐	12 Keeping your vendor list and details	_____	☐
☐	13 Filing contracts, agreements and SOPs	_____	☐

DELEGATION LAW 3 · DELEGATE MESSY

Perfection delays delegation. Don't clean it up, hand it off. Show it once, the way you do it today, and let them improve it.

WEEK 1 SCORE

____ / 13
handed off

The follow-ups

These live in your memory. Moving them out of your head is where the week starts coming back.

STILL MINE	TASK	HAND TO	HANDED OFF
☐	14 Keeping every promise in your memory	_____	☐
☐	15 Tracking what you owe others, and what they owe you	_____	☐
☐	16 Drafting follow-ups to clients who haven't replied in a week	_____	☐
☐	17 Chasing the follow-ups that slipped	_____	☐
☐	18 Checking which emails and calls from the last 3 days never got a reply	_____	☐
☐	19 Reminding clients about unpaid invoices	_____	☐
☐	20 Blocking time for your priority work	_____	☐
☐	21 Prepping for every meeting: who, why it matters, your last interaction, what you promised	_____	☐
☐	22 Looking up background on the people you're about to meet	_____	☐
☐	23 Logging decisions so they don't live in your head	_____	☐
☐	24 Paying contractors on time	_____	☐
☐	25 Tracking team PTO and holidays	_____	☐

DELEGATION LAW 6 · SILENCE IS NEGLIGENCE

Feedback is an obligation, not a favor. Check in daily for the first two weeks, even for ten minutes, then move to a weekly sync.

WEEK 2 SCORE

____ / 12
handed off

The systems

Now the help starts building the systems, so the work stops depending on you being in the room.

STILL MINE	TASK	HAND TO	HANDED OFF
☐	26 Writing SOPs yourself	_____	☐
☐	27 Cleaning up a process before you hand it off	_____	☐
☐	28 Keeping "how things get done" in your head	_____	☐
☐	29 Documenting how your internal systems work	_____	☐
☐	30 Building automations (e.g. in N8N)	_____	☐
☐	31 Running and maintaining the automations you already have	_____	☐
☐	32 Building AI agents for repeat workflows	_____	☐
☐	33 Learning every new AI tool as it launches	_____	☐
☐	34 Making social posts	_____	☐
☐	35 Turning one post format you like into a batch of posts	_____	☐
☐	36 Collecting testimonials and asking permission to reuse them	_____	☐
☐	37 Doing the research before a decision	_____	☐

DELEGATION PLAY · WHEN IN DOUBT, DELEGATE THE RESEARCH

Not sure how something should work? Don't figure it out first. Hand over the question and ask for options.

WEEK 3 SCORE

_____/12
handed off

The outcomes

The help stops taking tasks and starts owning results. This is the week you hand over outcomes, not steps.

STILL MINE	TASK	HAND TO	HANDED OFF
☐	38 Spelling out every step instead of handing over the outcome	_____	☐
☐	39 Running point on critical projects	_____	☐
☐	40 Keeping track of every open opportunity	_____	☐
☐	41 Following up on deals so they aren't lost	_____	☐
☐	42 Handling client requests and check-ins	_____	☐
☐	43 Being customer service for your own company	_____	☐
☐	44 Keeping partners and investors updated so nothing gets dropped	_____	☐
☐	45 Tracking open loops across several companies	_____	☐
☐	46 Tracking the decisions waiting on you, and what's blocking them	_____	☐
☐	47 Being the go-between for suppliers, agencies and freelancers	_____	☐
☐	48 Managing your freelancers	_____	☐
☐	49 Writing your own daily brief: priorities, meetings, promises owed	_____	☐
☐	50 Spotting what else on your plate someone else should own	_____	☐

DELEGATION PLAY · PROJECTS, NOT TASKS

Delegate outcomes, not steps to follow. When in doubt, default to their judgment. Give authorship or keep ownership.

WEEK 4 SCORE

____ / 13
handed off

The Hand-Off Brief

Most hand-offs fail before they start: the founder explains the steps and keeps the outcome. Fill this in once per task or project. Define what goes in and what should come out, and trust the middle.

Task or project Pick one from the list.	Owner
The outcome What does done look like? Describe the result, not the steps.	
What they get from you Access, logins, examples, contacts, the way you do it today (messy is fine).	
Guardrails Deadline, budget, and anything they must never do without asking.	
Their call Decisions they can make without you. Default to their judgment.	
Check-in When you'll look at progress: daily for the first two weeks, then weekly.	

THE RULE BEHIND IT

Authorship = Ownership. When in doubt, default to their judgment. Give authorship or keep ownership. You can't have both.

"You have mastered delegation when your **absence improves outcomes.**"

Delegation Law 1 · You = Bottleneck

HANDED OFF

_____ / 50

STILL MINE

_____ / 50

What still runs through you?

What did your week get back?

Which outcome will you hand over next?

If the list still runs through you, it isn't a discipline problem. It's a **structural** one.

NEXT STEP

Weeks 1 to 3 can go to almost anyone.
Week 4 needs someone who owns outcomes.

If you run a profitable business and still hold most of this list, book a Matching Call: within 24 hours you'll get three hand-picked, top-1% Right Hands who work your hours and own outcomes, not tasks, and if none of them is the one, you walk away owing nothing.

3

hand-picked profiles
in 24 hours

1 in 1,000

applicants make it
(top 1%)

\$0

if none of them
is the one

A VA	A PARETO RIGHT HAND
Waits for instructions	Anticipates and closes loops before you ask
Owens tasks	Owens outcomes
Stops when the task is done	Updates the tracker, blocks your time, flags the conflict
"I don't know that tool"	Builds the automation or AI agent for it
Often part-time	Full-time, dedicated, works your hours

Book your Matching Call →

Not a VA. A Right Hand. Latin America-based, fluent in English, trained on the AI stack, and matched to how you actually work.